

ELA.4.C.3.1

The Basics of Subject Verb Agreement



Subject Verb Agreement

Refers to the rule that a singular subject takes a singular verb, while a plural subject takes a plural verb.



PART 1:

Subject Verb Agreement

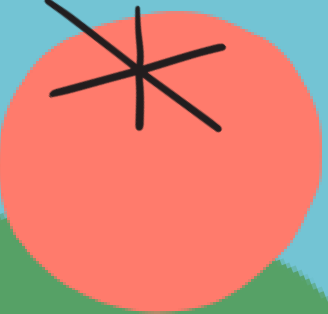


Rule #1

If the subject is singular (one person or thing), use a singular verb (usually ends in -s or -es).

Rule #2

If the subject is plural (more than one person or thing), use a plural verb (no -s at the end).



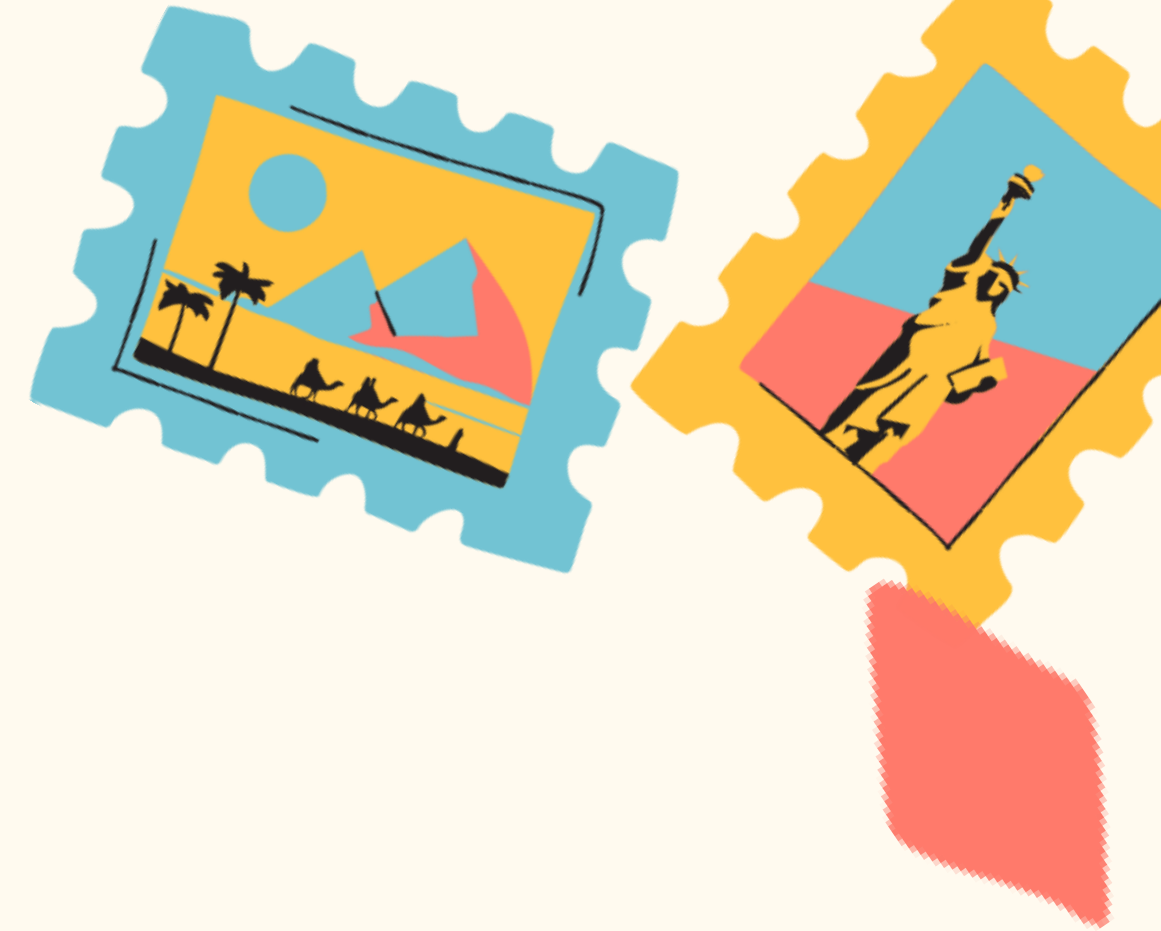
QUESTION #1:

Write down the correct verb that agrees with the subject.

My older sister _____ a large collection of vintage
postage stamps.

has

have



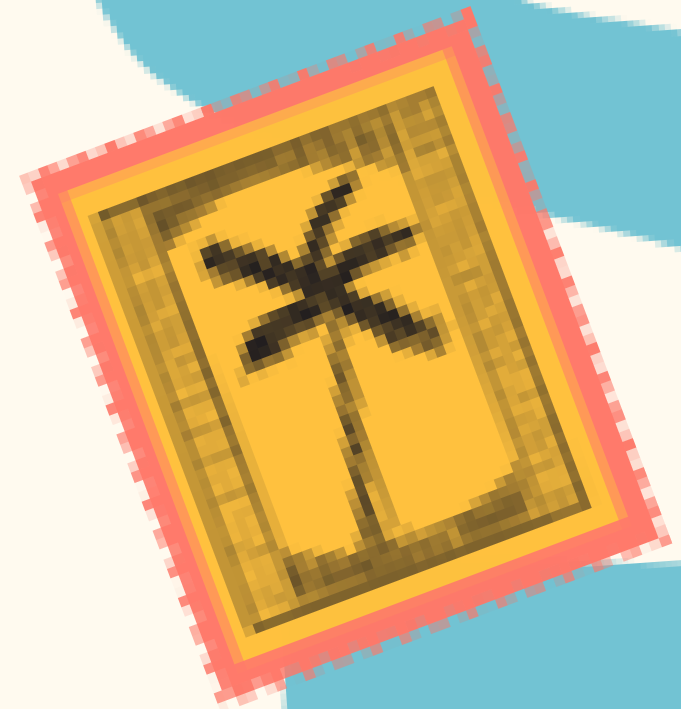
QUESTION #2:

Write down the correct verb that agrees with the subject.

Vintage postage stamps _____ interesting documents of how people lived in the past.

is

are



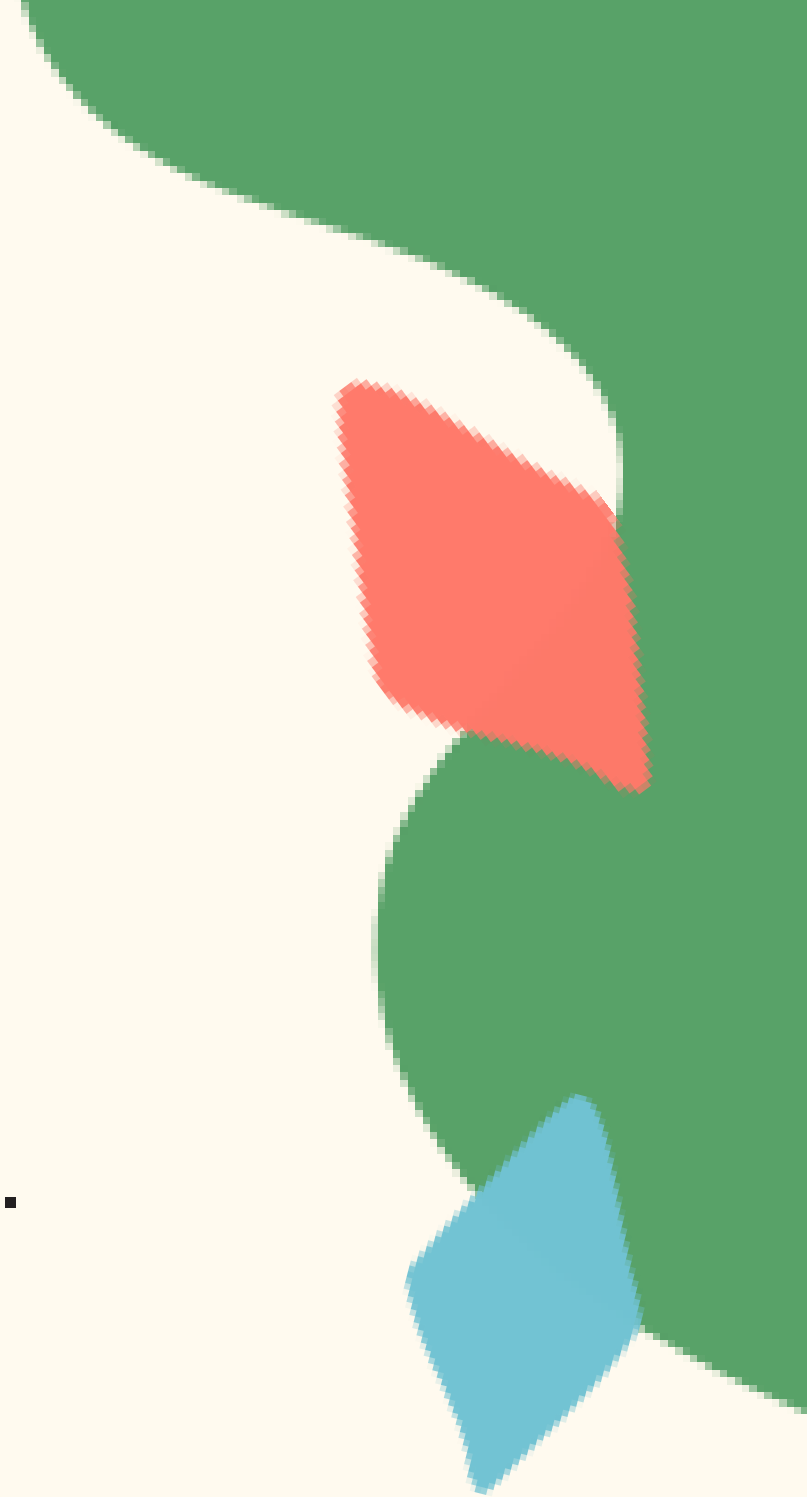
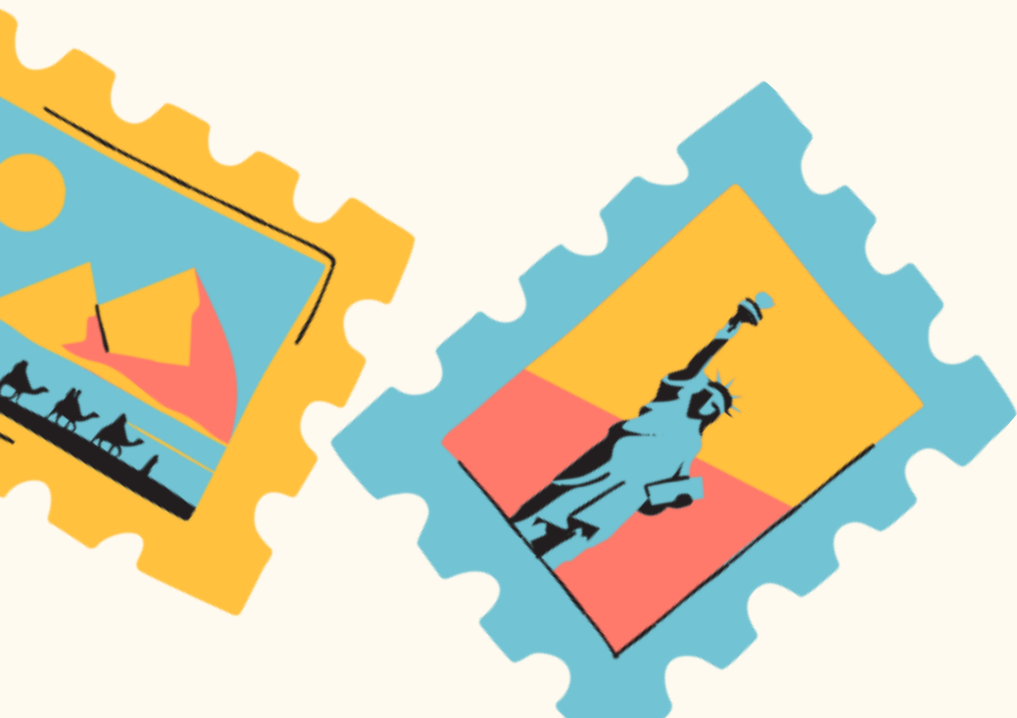
QUESTION #3:

Write down the correct verb that agrees with the subject.

Stamp collecting _____ a rare hobby nowadays.

is

are



LET'S CHECK OUR ANSWERS!

1. has

The singular subject "sister" is paired with the singular verb "has."

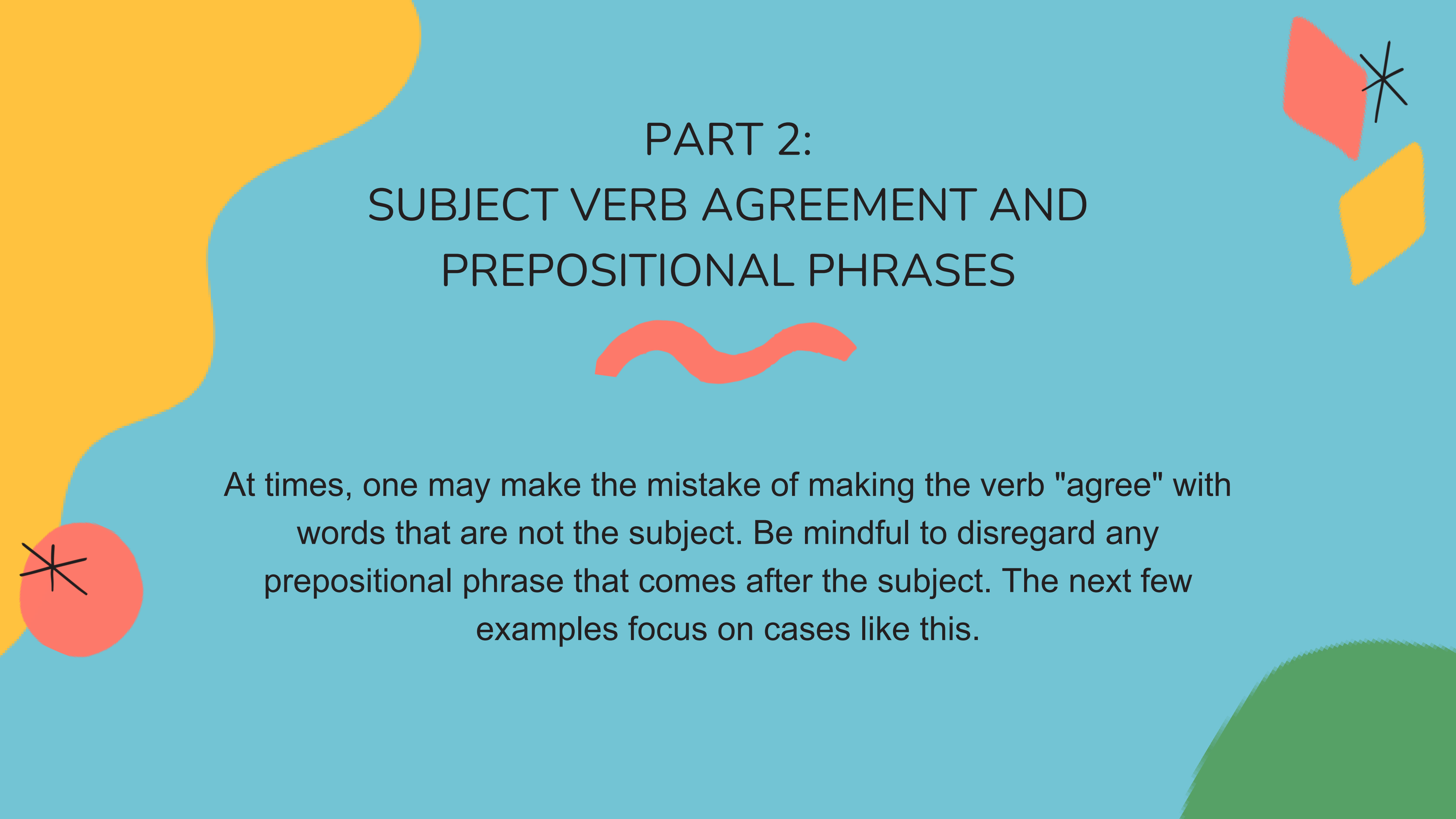
2. are

The plural subject "stamps" takes the plural verb "are."

3. is

"Stamp collecting" is taken as singular; therefore, "is" is the correct verb.





PART 2: SUBJECT VERB AGREEMENT AND PREPOSITIONAL PHRASES

At times, one may make the mistake of making the verb "agree" with words that are not the subject. Be mindful to disregard any prepositional phrase that comes after the subject. The next few examples focus on cases like this.

QUESTION #4:

Write down the correct verb that agrees with the subject.

Mammals that live in the ocean
_____ dolphins, whales, and
sea otters.

includes

include



QUESTION #5:

Write down the correct verb that agrees with the subject.

The number of birds in the Amazon rainforest
_____ to be almost 4000.

is estimated

are estimated



QUESTION #6:

Write down the correct verb that agrees with the subject.

The ecosystem of savannahs
_____ many threats caused by
human activity.

face

faces



LET'S CHECK OUR ANSWERS!

4. include

Disregard the phrase "that live in the ocean" so that you are left with the plural subject "mammals."

5. is estimated

In this example, the subject is the word singular "number," which would make the corresponding verb singular as well.

6. faces

The word "ecosystem" (and not "savannahs") is singular, which would make the correct verb "faces."



QUESTION #7:

Write down the correct verb that agrees with the subject.

The total cost of the party _____ hundreds of dollars more than the original budget.

was

were

QUESTION #8:

Write down the correct verb that agrees with the subject.

The laughter and noise of the
guests _____ a testament to the
success of the party.

was

were



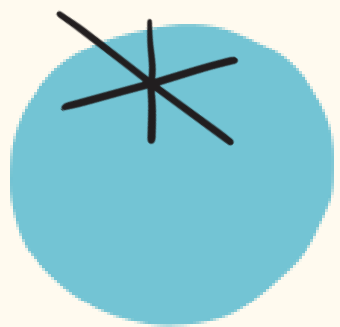
QUESTION #9:

Write down the correct verb that agrees with the subject.

The joy of my mom's life _____ her grandchildren,
who were there at the party.

is

are



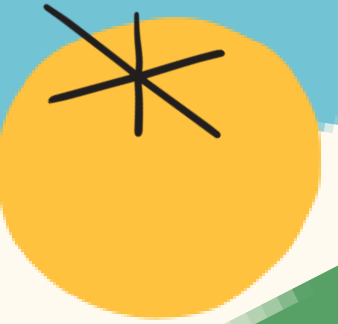
QUESTION #10:

Write down the correct verb that agrees with the subject.

The yellow roses in the vase
_____ a gift to my mom.

is

are



LET'S CHECK OUR ANSWERS!

7. was

In this example, the subject "cost" takes the verb "was."

8. were

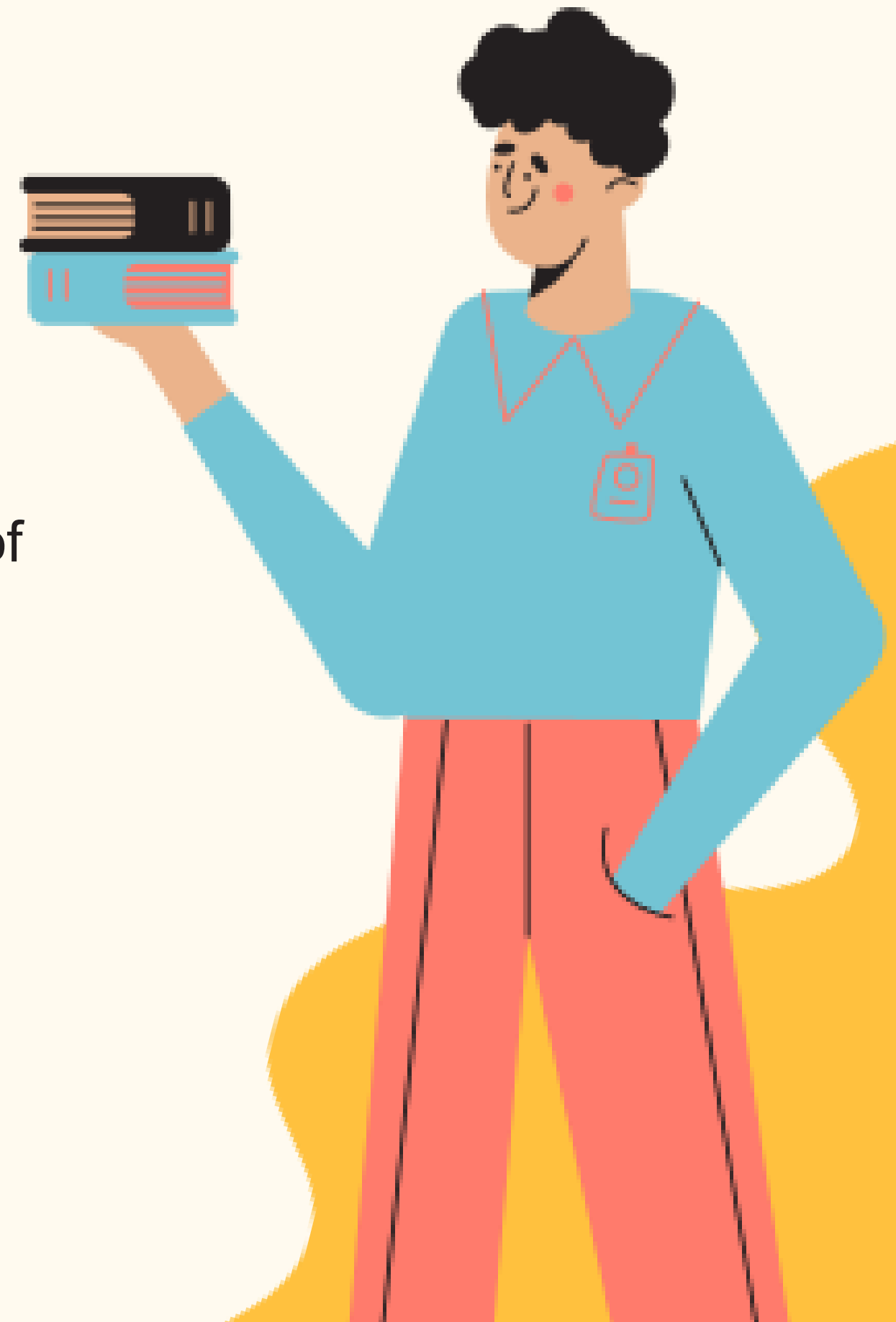
The verb "were" agrees with the subject "the laughter and noise of the guests" --not the predicate nominative "testament."

9. is

The subject "joy" agrees with the singular verb "is."

10. are

The plural subject "roses" takes the verb "are."



You're done reviewing the basics of Subject Verb Agreement!

Remember that:

- Singular subjects are paired with singular verbs, and plural subjects are paired with plural verbs.
- Prepositional phrases can make things seem tricky; it is good practice to pay no mind to any prepositional phrases that follow the subject.
- For sentences with linking verbs, the verb should always agree with the subject.

